Introduction to Fractions

Exam code: 0607

Download PDF

Written by: Naomi C
Reviewed by: Dan Finlay
Updated on 26 January 2026

Introduction to fractions

What is a fraction?

- A fraction is written as $\frac{a}{b}$ where a and b are **integers**
  - The number on the top, a, is called the **numerator**
  - The number on the bottom, b, is called the **denominator**
- The **values** of the numerator and denominator tell us about the **size** of the fraction
  - The denominator is how many **parts** each whole number is split into
  - The numerator is how many **parts** you **have**
    - For example, $\frac{2}{3}$ means that each whole number is divided into 3 parts and you have 2 of these parts
- A fraction is **less** than 1 if the numerator is **smaller** than the denominator
- A fraction is **more** than 1 if the number is **bigger** than the denominator

How do I shade a fraction on a diagram?

- **Divide** by the **denominator** and **multiply** by the **numerator**
  - To shade $\frac{3}{5}$ of a grid of 20 squares
    - **Divide** 20 squares by 5 to get 4 squares
    - **Multiply** this amount by 3 to get 12 squares
    - **Shade** 12 squares
  - To shade $\frac{1}{4}$ of a circle
    - **Divide** the circle into four quarters by drawing a horizontal and a vertical line through the centre
    - **Shade** one of these quarters

Help me understand

Stuck on something?

Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

Got it

Worked Example

Answer:

Count the total number of squares in the grid

Total of 21 squares

Divide 21 by 7

$21 \div 7 = 3$

Multiply by 5

$3 \times 5 = 15$

Shade 15 squares

- It doesn't matter which 15 you shade
- It's neater to group them together

Teacher only

Test your students on this in just a few clicks

- Create exam-aligned tests
- Tailor format & difficulty
- Quizzes or homework in minutes

Try Test Builder

Test yourself

Was this revision note helpful? Yes No

Resources

Learning Hub
Scholarship
Join
Past Papers
Solution Banks
Sitemap

Dashboard

Overview
Brand ambassador
Profile
Subscription
Settings
Log out

Company

About us
Exam Specificity
Content Quality
Promotions
Jobs
Terms
Privacy
Cookie Policy
Help and Support

Subjects

Biology
Chemistry
Physics
Maths
Geography
English Literature
Psychology
All Subjects

© Copyright 2015–2026 Save My Exams Ltd. All Rights Reserved.
Neither IBO nor College Board were involved in the production of, and do not endorse, the resources created by Save My Exams.